SEO Audit & Changelog: Blog Post "Best Destin SEO Company: How to Choose the Right Partner for Your Business"

URL: **https://rockstar-marketing.com/best-destin-seo-company-how-to-choose-the-right-partner-for-your-business/** · Post ID 12308 · WPBakery · Category: Uncategorized
Audit date: 2026-10-25 · Published / modified 2025-10-15 · Item 33 of 34 in the site queue

Summary. This is the **best-written post on the site**: about 11,200 words, accurate and honest, with real Destin market insight (tourist vs. local search, seasonality, industry competition tiers, the 30A geography problem), a strong red-flag/green-flag framework and **published pricing tiers** ($1,000–2,000 / $2,000–4,000 / $4,000–8,000+ per month). It needs targeting and clean-up, not a rewrite:

- **Keyword overlap with Home:** the title leads with "Best Destin SEO Company". Home ranks #1 for "destin seo company" (590/mo), and Semrush has no measurable volume for "best destin seo company". The guide's real search value is **"how to choose an SEO company" (880/mo, KD 25)**, "how to choose seo company" (320, KD 32) and **"questions to ask an seo company" (260, KD 14)**. Retitle around those and keep Destin as the angle.
- **Stuffed paragraph ×5:** "Remember we serve Pensacola, Gulf Breeze, Navarre, Fort Walton Beach, Niceville, Crestview, Freeport, Destin, Miramar Beach... Florida." is pasted into the middle of unrelated sections 5 times.
- **Pasted AI chat markup:** about 430 `class="whitespace-normal break-words text-text-100 …"` attributes (about 17KB) copied from an AI chat interface's HTML. They add weight and show where the text came from.
- **Two H1s** (content + theme), **2 internal links** on an 11,000-word page, no meta, Uncategorized, no images.
- **A few outdated terms:** "Search Generative Experience (SGE)" → AI Overviews; "Webmaster Guidelines" → Google Search Essentials; Zomato (no longer active in the US).

Method note: the full post body (about 83,000 characters of text) was read via the WordPress connector; the live site couldn't be reached. Keyword data from Semrush US ("best destin seo company" returned no data).

1. Priority Fix List

#	Priority	Area	Issue → Fix
1	P1	Retarget / cannibalization	New title and H1: **"How to Choose an SEO Company in Destin: Questions, Red Flags & Real Pricing"**. Focus "how to choose an SEO company". Link to Home once with the anchor "Destin SEO company" so Home keeps the head term.
2	P1	"Remember we serve..." ×5	Delete all 5 pasted service-area paragraphs (in Link Building, Pricing, The 30A Factor, Technical Questions, and the Rockstar section). Replace them with **one** sentence in the closing section, linking /locations/ and the city SEO pages.
3	P1	Duplicate H1	Remove the content `<h1>` (the theme prints the post title).

4	P1	Meta	No SEO title, description or keyphrase (§2).
5	P1	Internal links	Only Home and a share.google GBP link. Add about 15 contextual links (§4). This post is the best place on the site to link to /seo/, /destin-seo-company/, the city SEO pages, /clients/ and /contact-us/.
6	P2	AI chat markup	Strip all `class="…"` attributes and wrapper `<div>`s (paste as plain text or use "Clear formatting"). About 17KB saved.
7	P2	Table of contents	An 11,000-word page with 10 H2s and 43 H3s needs a linked TOC after the intro, plus "Back to top" links.
8	P2	Awkward brand insertions	"Rockstar Marketing says that SEO requires 3–6 months..." (Synthesis) → "SEO requires..."; "You're now operating from a position of knowledge rather than hope, that is why you call Rockstar Marketing." → end at "...rather than hope." and keep the CTA in the dedicated Rockstar section.
9	P2	Outdated terms	SGE → Google AI Overviews (renamed in 2024); "Google's Webmaster Guidelines" → "Google Search Essentials"; drop Zomato (use OpenTable/Yelp); "Google My Business" mentions → Google Business Profile.
10	P2	Soft statistics	"Studies consistently show...", "miss 80% of valuable citation opportunities", "3–5x ROI over 12–18 months". Cite a source (e.g. Moz Local Search Ranking Factors, Google's "near me" research) or phrase as your own experience ("In our experience...").
11	P2	No visuals	Add 3–5 visuals: a pricing-tier table (as an HTML table), the month-by-month timeline graphic, a red/yellow/green flags checklist, and a map-pack screenshot. Add a downloadable "SEO consultation questions" checklist PDF as a lead magnet.
12	P2	Pricing consistency	This post publishes $1,000–$8,000+/month tiers. Use the same ranges in the [$X] placeholders on /seo/, the city SEO pages, /faq/ and post #32, so the site gives one consistent answer.
13	P3	Category / author	Uncategorized → SEO; named author with bio (strong E-E-A-T piece).
14	P3	Slug	Long (78 characters) but contains "how-to-choose". Keep it (published Oct 2025; avoid redirect churn).

2. Meta Tags & Search Appearance (AIOSEO)

Field	Current	New
Post title / H1	Best Destin SEO Company: How to Choose the Right Partner for Your Business	**How to Choose an SEO Company in Destin: Questions, Red Flags & Real Pricing**
SEO title	(empty)	**How to Choose an SEO Company: 25 Questions & Red Flags** (55)

Meta description	(empty)	**A Destin agency's honest guide to choosing an SEO company: questions to ask, red flags, real local SEO pricing ($1,000–$8,000/mo) and realistic timelines.** (153)
Focus keyphrase	(empty)	how to choose an SEO company
Additional	none	questions to ask an SEO company · how to choose SEO company · local SEO pricing · Destin SEO
Featured image	none	A "red flags vs green flags" checklist graphic (1200×630)

3. Heading Structure

The existing H2/H3 structure (10 H2s, 43 H3s) is logical and keeps most of its value. Changes:

Current	Change
H1 – Best Destin SEO Company: How to Choose...	Remove from content; post title becomes "How to Choose an SEO Company in Destin: Questions, Red Flags & Real Pricing"
(none)	**Add** after the intro: an answer box "How do you choose an SEO company? (Quick checklist)" with 7 bullets, then a TOC
H2 – Why Local SEO Is Critical for Destin's Tourism-Driven Economy	Keep
H2 – How Local SEO Actually Works: The Foundation	Keep
H2 – What the Best Destin SEO Companies Actually Do	→ "What a Good SEO Company Actually Does"
H2 – How to Evaluate Destin SEO Companies: A Professional Framework	→ "How to Evaluate an SEO Company: The 5-Pillar Framework"
H2 – Warning Signs and Quality Indicators	→ "SEO Company Red Flags, Yellow Flags and Green Flags"
H2 – Understanding SEO Pricing and Investment: Destin Market Reality	→ "How Much Does an SEO Company Cost in Destin?" + add a pricing table
H2 – How Long Does SEO Take?	Keep
H2 – The Destin SEO Landscape	Keep. H3 "Future Considerations: How AI Search Affects..." → update to AI Overviews/ChatGPT
H2 – Essential Questions to Ask During Your SEO Consultation	→ "**25 Questions to Ask an SEO Company**" (targets "questions to ask an seo company"). Number the questions.
H2 – Making Your Decision · H3 If You're Considering Rockstar Marketing	Keep, cleaned (remove the stuffed paragraph); add a CTA button

4. Internal Linking Plan

Anchor text	Target	Where
Destin SEO company	/ (Home)	Intro (supports Home's #1)
SEO services	/seo/	"What a good SEO company does" + Rockstar section
Google Business Profile optimization	/destin-seo-company/	"Why your GBP is critical"
Do you even need an SEO company?	post #32 (/do-you-need-an-seo-company/ once retitled)	Intro
Destin social media company	/destin-social-media-company/	Review economy
Destin web design	/web-design/	Technical foundation
AI search optimization	/ai-marketing/	AI search H3
Santa Rosa Beach & 30A SEO · Fort Walton Beach SEO · Pensacola SEO	city SEO pages	30A Factor H3 + closing
Miramar Beach & Sandestin	/miramar-beach-social-media-company/	30A Factor H3
all areas we serve	/locations/	Closing (replaces the 5 stuffed lists)
our client results	/clients/	"Can you show me examples" question
our FAQ	/faq/#seo	Timeline section
Get a free SEO audit	/contact-us/?service=seo	Rockstar section + after the pricing section
Google Business Profile *(keep)*	share.google link	n/a
Inbound (to add)	/seo/ ("How to choose an SEO company"), Home (FAQ section), post #32, /faq/ SEO answers	other pages

5. Content Additions & Edits (ready to paste)

`NEW answer box after intro` **How do you choose an SEO company? Quick checklist**

- They explain how Google's local algorithm works (relevance, distance, prominence) in plain English
- They audit your site and competitors *before* quoting
- They give you a specific monthly work plan and sample reports
- You own every account: Google Analytics, Search Console, Google Business Profile
- They show real, verifiable results and rank well themselves
- Pricing matches your competition level (most Destin businesses: $2,000–$4,000/month)
- No guaranteed rankings, no secret methods, no long lock-in contracts

`NEW pricing table under "How Much Does an SEO Company Cost in Destin?"`

Tier	Monthly	Best for	Typical results
Foundational Local SEO	$1,000–$2,000	Low-competition services, niche businesses	Map pack for niche terms; steady presence
Competitive Local SEO	$2,000–$4,000	Restaurants, retail, tours, professional services	Top-3 map pack + page one in 6–12 months
Aggressive / Dominant	$4,000–$8,000+	Vacation rentals, real estate, multi-location	Rankings for the most competitive terms

`EDIT AI H3` Replace "Google's Search Generative Experience (SGE)" with "Google's AI Overviews and AI Mode, along with ChatGPT and Perplexity,". Add: "See how we approach AI search optimization."

`EDIT closing (replaces 5 stuffed paragraphs)` "We're based in Destin and work with businesses across the Emerald Coast, from Pensacola and Fort Walton Beach to Santa Rosa Beach and 30A. See all the areas we serve."

`EDIT Rockstar section` Add after the paragraph "We practice what we've outlined here...": `button` [Get a Free SEO Audit] → /contact-us/?service=seo · or call (850) 542-3091.

`NEW lead magnet (optional)` "Download: 25 Questions to Ask an SEO Company (PDF checklist)": a gated form that feeds Quform → lead.

6. Tracking & Measurement

Priority	Item	Action

P1	Cannibalization check	GSC: make sure "destin seo company" impressions stay on Home after the retitle. This post should collect "how to choose..." / "questions to ask..." queries.
P1	Position tracking	"how to choose an seo company" (880), "how to choose seo company" (320), "questions to ask an seo company" (260).
P2	Engagement	Scroll depth 25/50/75/90% (an 11,000-word page) + `toc_click`; `cta_click` (post_choose_seo); `file_download` if the checklist PDF is added.
P3	Assisted leads	GA4 path: post → /seo/ or /contact-us/ → generate_lead.

7. Technical SEO

Priority	Item	Finding / Action
P1	Single H1	Remove the content H1.
P2	Markup weight	Strip about 430 chat-UI class attributes and nested divs (about 17KB of 107KB).
P2	Schema	`BlogPosting` (author Person, dates, image, wordCount) + `BreadcrumbList`. No FAQPage (FAQ-09).
P2	TOC + anchors	Add ids to the H2s (#questions, #pricing, #red-flags) so other pages can deep-link.
P3	Builder	WPBakery inside a post. Optional move to the block editor (consistent with the YouTube post).

8. Changelog

Date	ID	Type	Change	Status
2026-10-25	BD-01	Change	Retitle to "How to Choose an SEO Company in Destin..."; focus "how to choose an SEO company"; SEO title + description	Proposed
2026-10-25	BD-02	Remove	5× pasted "Remember we serve..." paragraphs → 1 linked sentence	Proposed
2026-10-25	BD-03	Fix	Remove the content H1; strip AI-chat class markup	Proposed
2026-10-25	BD-04	Add	Quick-checklist answer box, TOC, pricing table, CTA buttons, optional checklist PDF	Proposed
2026-10-25	BD-05	Change	Rename 5 H2s for search intent ("25 Questions to Ask an SEO Company", "How Much Does an SEO Company Cost in Destin?", ...)	Proposed
2026-10-25	BD-06	Fix	SGE → AI Overviews; Webmaster Guidelines → Search Essentials; Zomato; awkward brand insertions; soften/cite stats	Proposed

2026-10-25	BD-07	Add	~15 internal links (Home, /seo/, GBP, city pages, Locations, Clients, AI page, post #32, Contact)	Proposed
2026-10-25	BD-08	Site-wide	Use this post's pricing tiers to fill the [$X] placeholders on /seo/, the city pages, the FAQ and post #32	Proposed
2026-10-25	BD-09	Add	3–5 visuals + featured image; category SEO; named author	Proposed
2026-10-25	BD-10	Tracking	GSC cannibalization check; position tracking; scroll/TOC/CTA/download events	Proposed

Status: DONE (audit complete) · Next in queue: Portfolio item (last item)